

## Chile

### Fiscalía Nacional Económica

#### I. Intelligence Unit

In September 2020, the Fiscalía Nacional Económica (‘FNE’) launched the Intelligence Unit (‘IU’), which is a multidisciplinary team within the Anti-Cartel Division, composed of a lawyer, a data scientist/economist, and a software engineer, that develops computational investigative tools to support and optimize cartel investigations. In 2025, the team is expected to grow stronger with the addition of two professionals specializing in economics and data science. The Unit plays a pivotal role in the FNE’s ongoing efforts to combat cartels and align its investigative techniques with global standards.

The FNE has prioritized an in-house development strategy to embed in its computational tools the specific knowledge of lawyers and economists working in the office, and, by doing so, meet in a better manner the investigative needs of the institution. This approach has proven effective. Computational techniques designed by the IU have been handy not only in cartel detection but also in helping lawyers and economists within the FNE to work with large volumes of data. In addition, the FNE continues to enhance its computational investigative capabilities, leveraging recent advances in artificial intelligence.

In our previous contribution to the annual report, we described an automated web-based data collection tool and a platform to analyze public tenders based on screening techniques, both to improve cartel detection. We also showcased data-analysis systems that streamline information provided by public agencies—such as the National Customs Service—and facilitate the organization and analysis of phone-call logs and georeferenced data from mobile devices. In this contribution, we share the updates on these projects and outline our most recent development work.

##### *A. Market Screening*

One significant contribution of the IU is the development of computational tools to facilitate market screening. To date, three tools have been released. The first is an automated web-based system that assembles and stores market information. It allows FNE professionals to answer consumer complaints and expand their information sources in ongoing cases. Since its implementation, the tool has

collected, processed and stored daily price information for over eighty thousand products.

The second tool, not mentioned in the previous contribution, is an automated, web-based data collector that focuses on gathering news from digital media platforms. It helps FNE's investigators to stay updated on specific topics relevant to ongoing cases. This system has been especially useful for monitoring at a regional level, given that it covers news from local media nationwide. It has collected, processed and stored approximately three hundred and sixty thousand news articles from over fifteen digital media platforms. The system will soon be upgraded with a machine-learning algorithm trained to flag cartel-related news gathered by the web-based data collector, streamlining the entire process.

The third tool systematizes data published by the Customs National Service from 2007 to date. It has been used to identify the leading importers and exporters of certain products, estimate concentration levels in their markets, and track price variations. All FNE divisions can now use the tool, and in many cases it has removed the need for formal information requests, resulting in significant investigative efficiencies.

#### *B. Computational Tools Designed for Cartel Investigations*

To make cartel investigations more efficient, the IU has developed a computational tool that analyses past public tenders based on screening techniques. It leverages data that the FNE receives under its cooperation agreement with the public procurement agency of Chile, ChileCompra. The platform has significantly reduced the time needed to collect and review large datasets, improving the detection of anticompetitive behavior in procurement processes.

Finally, the IU has developed other new tools to help investigation teams, such as simple coding scripts to help them visualize phone logs data and the implementation of deep learning-trained algorithms that identify text in images from mobile devices data obtained through dawn raids.